

The snake's skin comes off inside out – like a sock being peeled off a human's foot.

Old skin, new skin

To get rid of older, worn-out scales, all reptiles shed their outer layer of skin from time to time. This is called molting or sloughing. Snakes shed their whole skin in one piece, starting at the head.

This armored spiny lizard has conelike, spiked scales along the full length of its backbone (spine).

The skin of a reptile is not very good at holding on to body heat.

Scales are extra-thick pieces of skin.

Reptile file

- A reptile's outer scales are mostly made up of something called keratin, which also goes into making human hair and fingernails.
- Lizards lose their skin bit by bit as it falls off in large flakes. Some peel it off with their mouth and eat it as food.